



FOOTBALL  
QUEENSLAND



CLUBS &  
COMMUNITY

# MINIROOS

## MODEL SESSIONS



FOOTBALL  
QUEENSLAND



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# OVERVIEW

Thank you for completing our **Mini-Roos certificate!**

You're now equipped with the tools to create fun, safe, inclusive and engaging football experiences for your young players. To help you get started, we've included some sample session plans. Remember, these are just a starting point! Feel free to adapt them using **SOCHANGEIT** to suit your team's specific needs.

Yours in football!

## FQ Coach Education Team

|          |                                                                                                             |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>S</b> | <b>SAFE</b><br>Physically free from hazards and danger. Emotionally safe and supportive environment.        |
| <b>O</b> | <b>OBSERVE</b><br>Is everything set up as you would like? Does it look like football? Is everyone engaged?  |
| <b>C</b> | <b>COACHING STYLES</b><br>How do you speak to the players? Too much/too little talk? Positive engagement.   |
| <b>H</b> | <b>HOW TO SCORE</b><br>Do they know how to score/get points? Goals involved, number of passes, end zones.   |
| <b>A</b> | <b>AREA</b><br>Does the area size suit the players/activity/game? Increase or decrease accordingly.         |
| <b>N</b> | <b>NUMBERS</b><br>Even or uneven? Do the teams need changing to maximise participation?                     |
| <b>G</b> | <b>GAME RULES</b><br>Change rules to engage everyone. Only tackle from in front, if Sarah scores = 3 goals. |
| <b>E</b> | <b>EQUIPMENT</b><br>Different coloured cones and bibs. Lots of footballs, more goals, bigger/smaller goals. |
| <b>I</b> | <b>INCLUSION</b><br>Everyone involved and engaged. Give every player a little bit of your time.             |
| <b>T</b> | <b>TIME</b><br>Reduce or extend time to increase motivation and enjoyment. Add time limits to score.        |



**BE G.O.O.D**

**START AND END  
WITH PLAY**

**GOALS  
OPPONENTS  
OPPORTUNITIES  
DIRECTION**



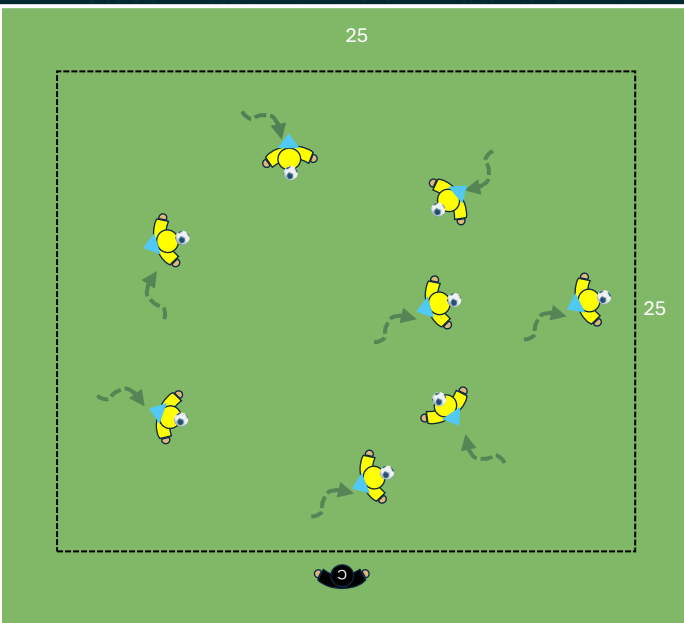
**CREATE T.O.E.S**

**TRAINING SHOULD  
ALWAYS HAVE**

**TOUCHES OF THE BALL  
ORGANISATION  
ENJOYMENT  
SAFETY**



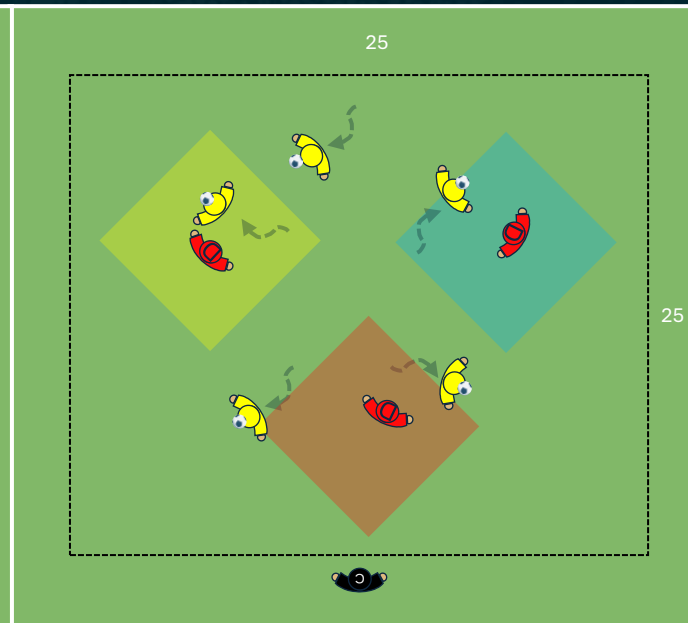
# SESSION STRUCTURE



## BEGINNING

Start your session with players playing a game on arrival (build numbers as players arrive - 1v1, 2v1, 2v2, 3v2 ect).

After 5-10 minutes, begin your first activity. The 'Beginning' activity should include lots of fun, activity and repetition of today's skill.

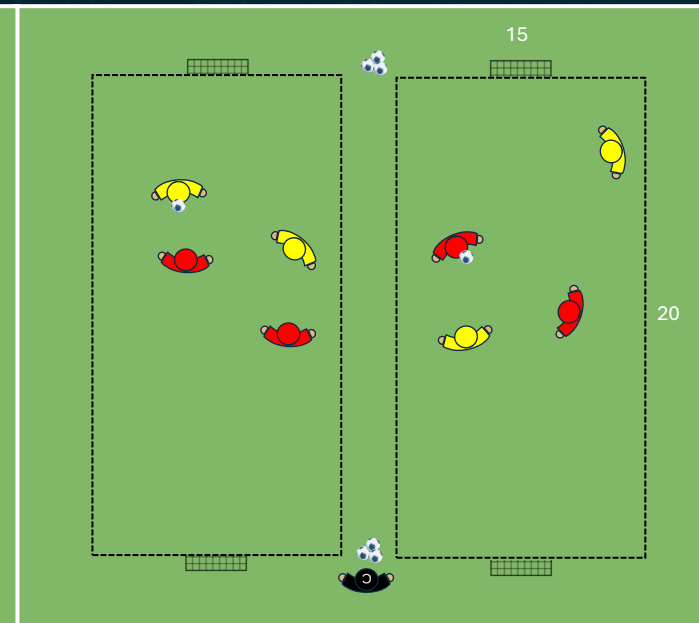


## MIDDLE

The 'middle' component should continue to expand on today's theme.

It should provide players with a lot of repetition of today's skill, usually with some pressure from a defender.

Keep it competitive whilst also being safe for your players.



## END

Finish your session with gameplay.

In this component you may choose to have some sort of reward for the players to encourage them to execute today's skill.

Let the players play – provide plenty of positive encouragement throughout.

# DRIBBLING #1

**Session Objective:** Improve our players technique and ability to dribble with **both** feet.

## On Arrival – Start with play!

### Beginning – Dribbling Gates

- All players start with a ball dribbling around the area,
- When coach shouts 'GO!', players have 30 seconds to dribble through as many gates as they can (can't go through the same gate twice in a row!).
- Check scores!

### Possible Progressions:

- Can you do a drag back away from the gate? (Show them how),
- Remove/Increase gates,
- Coach calls colour of gates players can use,
- Add a defender, if defender steals your ball and stops it, score resets.
- Change defenders each round.

### Coaching Points:

- Smaller touches in tight spaces, bigger touches in open space.
- Technique of dribbling (both feet, point foot down, inside and out of laces),
- Keep scanning and checking for space.

## Middle – Bugsplatter

- 1 to 3 players start with the ball in their hands, they are the bugsplatters,
- Everyone else starts by dribbling around the area, they are the bugs,
- The bugsplatters try to throw their ball and hit the bug's ball,
- If your ball gets hit, you become a bugsplatter too.
- Last bug dribbling wins.

### Possible Progressions:

- Bigger/smaller area,
- More/less Bugsplatters,
- Safe zones (can dribble into here for three seconds),
- Bugsplatters dribble too, pass your ball off the bugs to turn them into splatters.

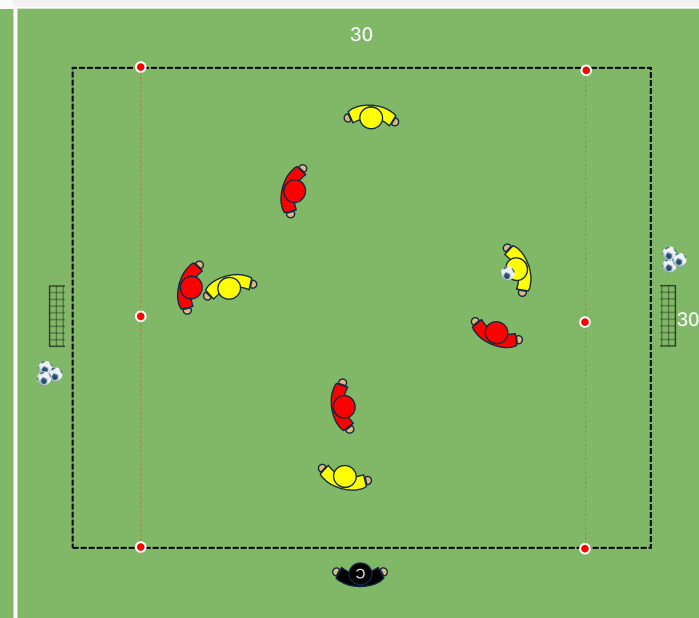
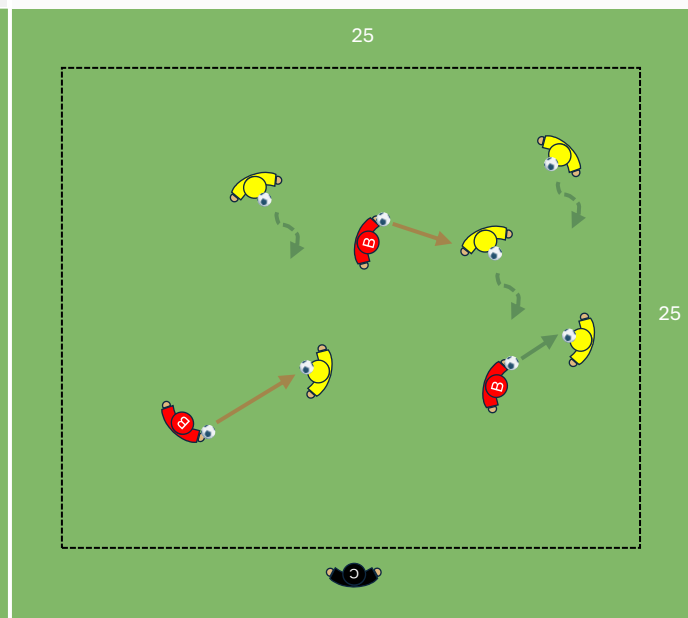
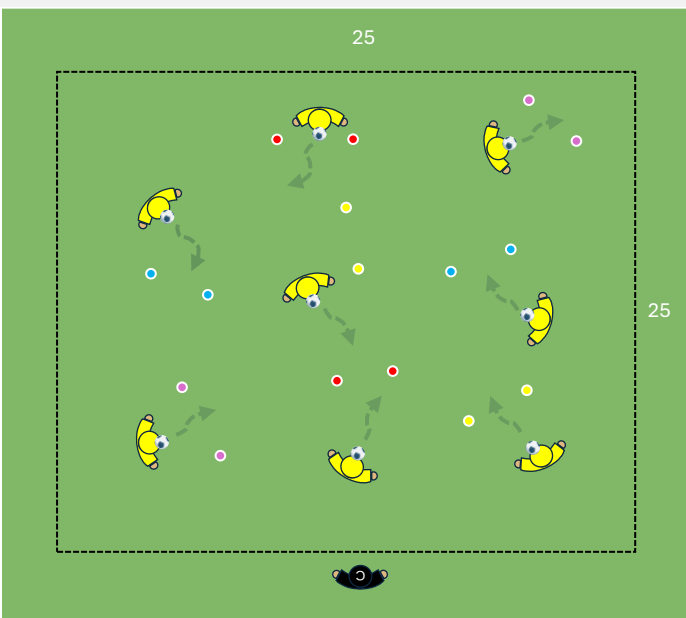
## End – Play With A Reward

- Finish session with a game,
- Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme,
- **Reward:** If you can dribble over the opponents final third line before scoring = 3 goals.
- Every other goal worth a point.

Encourage dribbling and praise effort. Allow the players the freedom to play!

### Coach Self Reflection:

- Did you create a T.O.E.S environment? (Touches of the ball, Organisation, Enjoyment and Safety).
- Did you start and end with play?
- Did you teach technique throughout the session?
- Were there smiles and laughter throughout the session?



# DRIBBLING #2

**Session Objective:** Improve our players technique and ability to dribble with **both** feet.

## On Arrival – Start with play!

### Beginning – Foxtails

- Every player has a bib tucked into the back of their shorts.
- Practice starts without a ball for the first two rounds.
- Players have 30 seconds to grab as many tails as they can, every time you win a tail you must tuck it into your shorts.
- if they don't lose their own tail by the end – that's worth 3 tails.
- Person with the most tails after 30 seconds wins.

### Possible Progressions:

- Each player now dribbling a ball, can't abandon ball.
- 1v1's – players play against their partner, first to steal bib wins.

### Coaching Points:

- Smaller touches in tight spaces, bigger touches in open space.
- Technique of dribbling (both feet, point foot down, inside and out of laces).
- Simple skill moves to get away from players (drag back, chop).
- Keep scanning and checking for space.

## Middle – 1v1 Squares

- Defender inside each square.
- Dribblers have 30 seconds to dribble in and out of as many squares as they can (can't go through the same one twice!)
- Defenders start with semi-pressure (force them to go one way!).
- Player's rotate roles every 30 seconds. Keep count of how many squares you can go through!

### Possible Progressions:

- Defenders go full pressure. If they win your ball, you're back to zero.
- Beat a defender with skill while going through square = 2 points.
- If defender steals your ball, you take their place as defender.

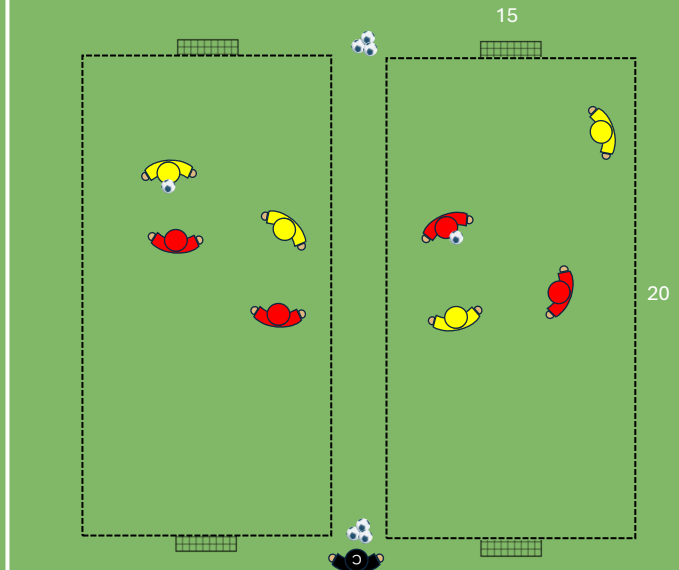
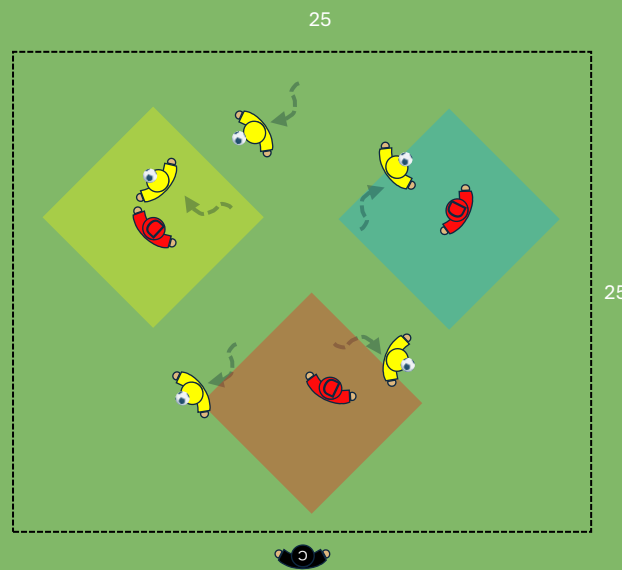
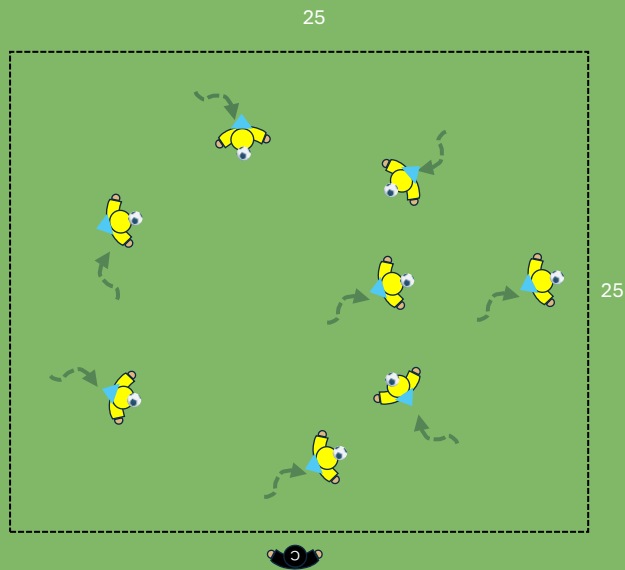
## End – Play With A Reward

- Finish session with a games,
- **Reward:** if you can dribble over the oppositions end of grid = 1 goal. Score into goal = 2 goals.
- Play as a tournament, with teams accumulating goals/points across each game.

Encourage dribbling and praise effort. Allow the players the freedom to play!

### Coach Self Reflection:

- Did you create a T.O.E.S environment? (Touches of the ball, Organisation, Enjoyment and Safety).
- Did you start and end with play?
- Did you teach technique throughout the session?
- Were there smiles and laughter throughout the session?



# DRIBBLING #3

**Session Objective:** Improve our players technique and ability to dribble with **both** feet.

## On Arrival – Start with play!

### Beginning – 4 Square Dribbling Game

- Players have a ball each and are dribbling around the area,
- When coach shouts a colour, players race to that square.
- First three players to that square receive a point. First to 5 wins.

### Possible Progressions:

- Coach shouts multiple colours (players race to each square),
- Add a central defender – all players start in one of the square – Coach shouts a colour and players must dribble to that square, if the defender steals your ball – you join the defenders – last player dribbling wins.

### Coaching Points:

- Smaller touches in tight spaces, bigger touches in open space.
- Technique of dribbling (both feet, point foot down, inside and out of laces),
- Keep scanning and checking for space.

### Middle – Shark Attack

- 1 to 3 Players start as 'Sharks',
- Rest of the players in one of the end zones ('beach') with a ball each ('Fish'),
- When the Sharks call 'GO!' the fish attempt to dribble across to the other end zone (beach).
- If a Sharks can steal your ball, you join them in the middle,
- Last person dribbling wins.

### Possible Progressions:

- More/Less Sharks to start.
- If too difficult, sharks only need to tag you.
- Add mini goals beyond each end zone, if a Shark wins your ball, they must score into mini goals to turn you into a Shark.

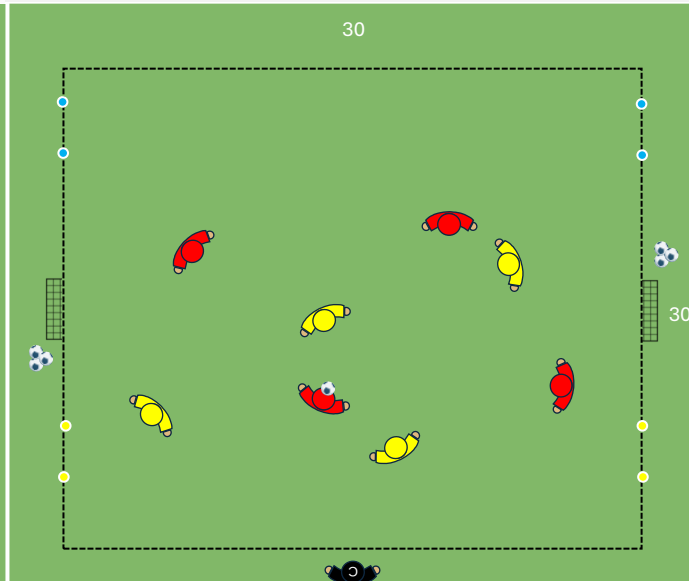
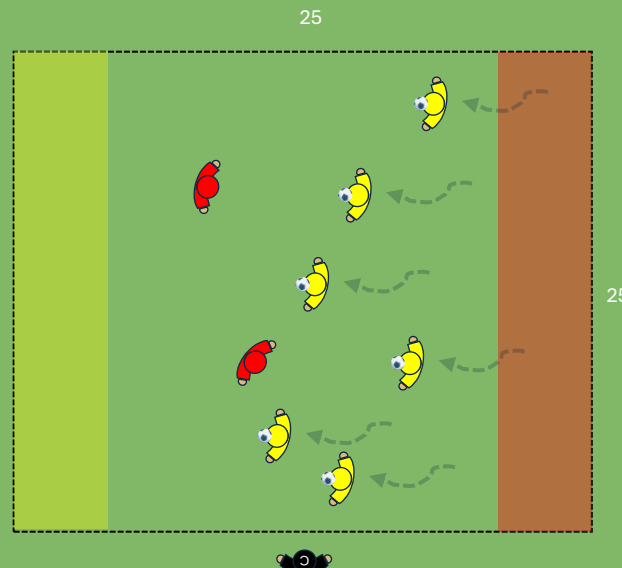
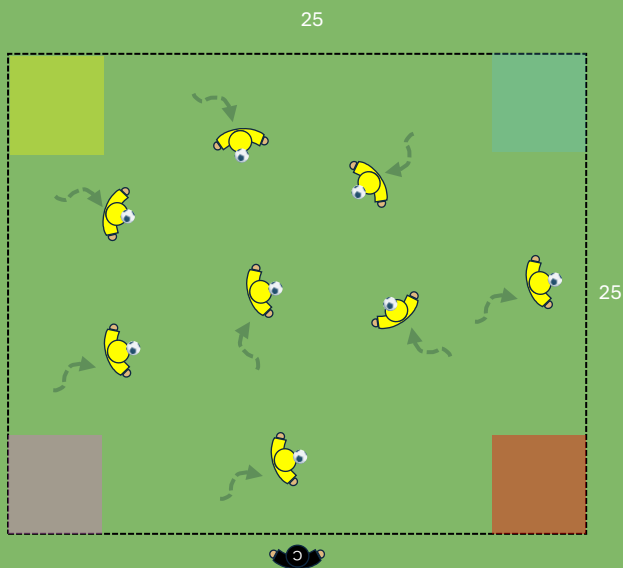
### End – Play With A Reward

- Finish session with a game,
- Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme,
- **Reward:** If you can dribble through one of the outside gates = 1 goal.
- If you can score into opponent's central goal = 3 goals.

Encourage dribbling and praise effort. Allow the players the freedom to play!

### Coach Self Reflection:

- Did you create a T.O.E.S environment? (Touches of the ball, Organisation, Enjoyment and Safety).
- Did you start and end with play?
- Did you teach technique throughout the session?
- Were there smiles and laughter throughout the session?



# PASSING / RECEIVING



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**Session Objective:** Improve our players technique and ability to pass with **both** feet.

## On Arrival – Start with play!

### Beginning – Football Marbles

- All players start with a ball dribbling around the area,
- When the coach shouts 'GO!', Players have 30 seconds to pass their ball and hit other player's footballs.
- Every time you hit a ball; you get a point.
- Person with the most points at the end wins!

### Possible Progressions:

- Bigger/Smaller area,
- 2 Points for a pass with other foot,
- Add a 'Boss' – If they hit your ball, your score resets, if you hit theirs = 100 points.

### Coaching Points:

- Inside of the foot pass (plant foot, lock ankle, swing back and then push through ball).
- Look up and check the target briefly before passing.

## Middle – Pirates

- 1 to 3 players start without a ball = Pirates,
- Everyone else dribbling around the area with their ball = treasure,
- Pirates have 30 seconds to steal as much 'treasure' as they can and then pass into the mini goal.
- If a Pirate steals your treasure and scores – you become a pirate too,
- Last player dribbling wins.

### Possible Progressions:

- Bigger/Smaller area,
- More/Less Pirates,
- Players work in pairs to keep one ball, both become defenders if pirates score.

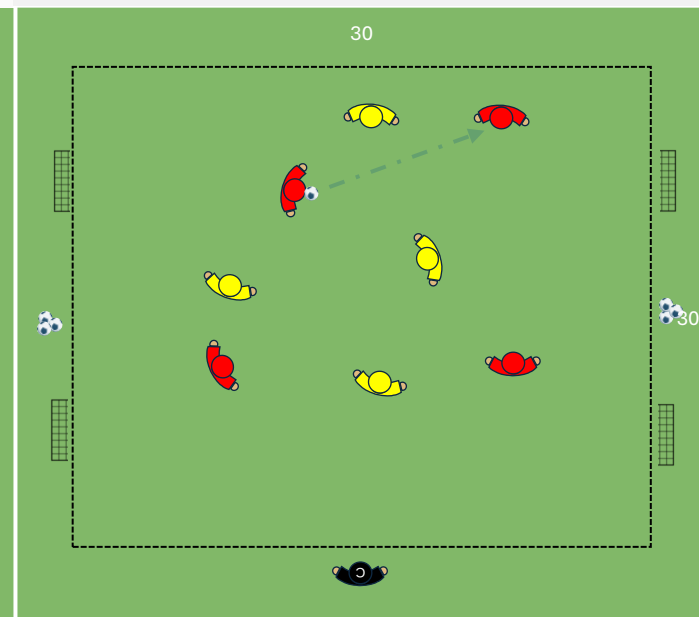
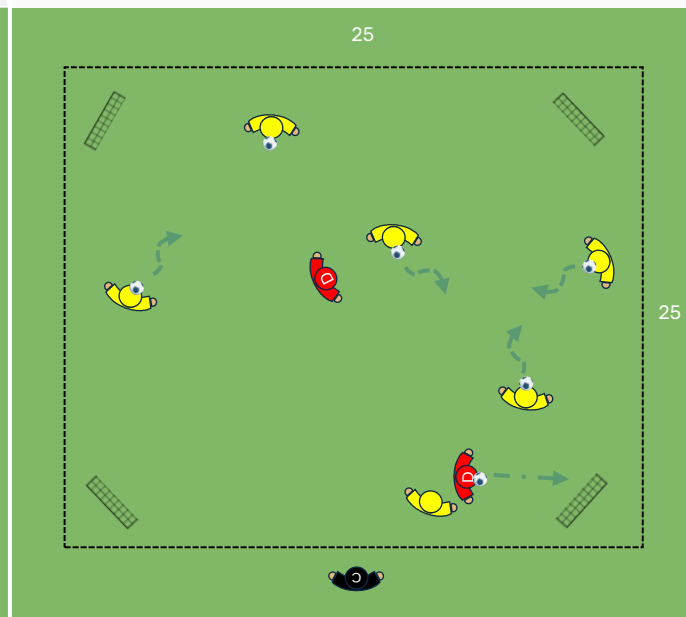
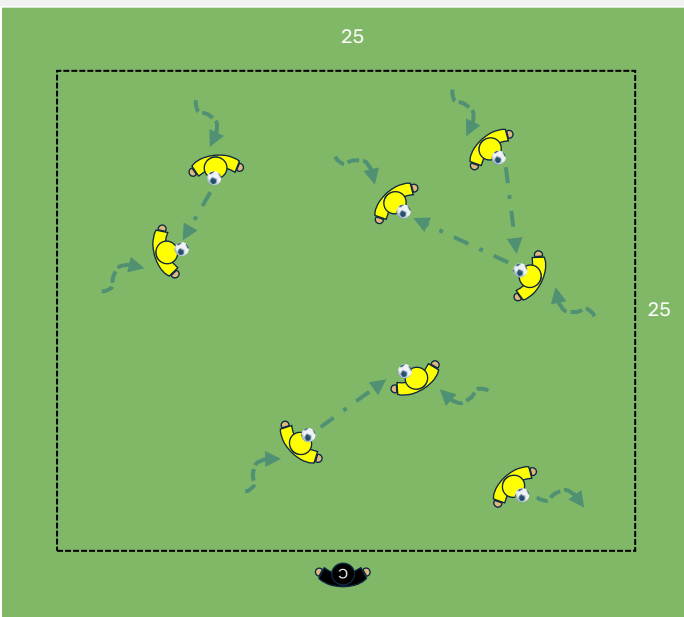
## End – Play With A Reward

- Finish session with a game,
- Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme,
- **Reward:** Number of passes before you score = goals, 0 passes = 1 goal.

Encourage passing and praise effort. Allow the players the freedom to play!

### Coach Self Reflection:

- Did you create a T.O.E.S environment? (Touches of the ball, Organisation, Enjoyment and Safety).
- Did you start and end with play?
- Did you teach technique throughout the session?
- Were there smiles and laughter throughout the session?



## Session Objective: Improve our players technique and ability to **either** attack or defend 1v1.

### On Arrival – Start with play!

#### Beginning – Copy The Coach

- Every player with a ball, dribbling around the area.
- Allow the players time to freestyle for 30 seconds and show all the skills they know.
- Break down a skill (what parts of the foot, where you should use it, step by step) and then ask players to repeat.
- Repeat for three skills.
- Always encourage effort and use of both feet.

#### Possible Progressions:

- Add a competitive element – ask players to complete each skill three times, best effort can demo to the rest of the group and receive applause!
- Add in defenders (semi pressure or full).

#### Coaching Points:

- Acceleration – Between skills and after,
- Scanning – be aware of surroundings!

### Middle – 1v1s Galore

- Players in pairs, 1 ball between two.
- Allocate each pair two goals (ensure that goals are opposite each other and the pairs are evenly spread).
- Players defend a goal each and play 1v1.
- All 1v1's are going at the same time, each game lasts 45 seconds.
- To begin with, when defending you can only force the opposition off the field, not tackle. Roles change when the ball is dead, or a goal is scored.

#### Possible Progressions:

- Rotate partners each round.
- Full pressure 1v1s.

#### Coaching Points:

##### Attacking 1v1s:

- First touch forward and attack quickly,
- Creativity – try different moves and see what works.

##### Defending 1v1s:

- Approach quickly but don't jump in, side on body shape to show away.
- Tacking Technique – Block, inside of foot, lock ankle.

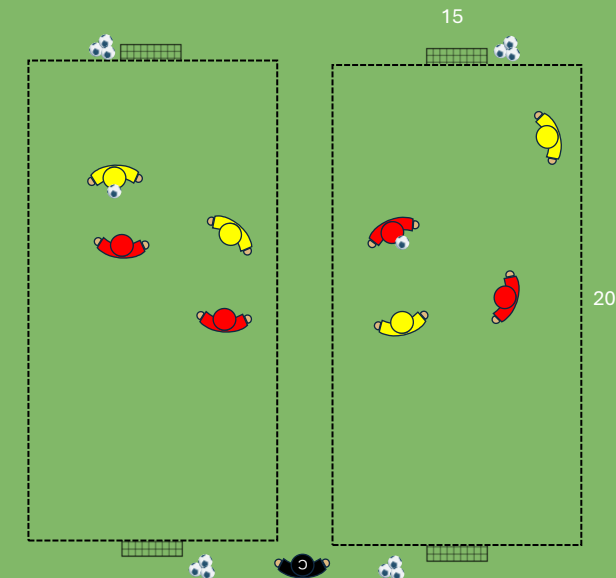
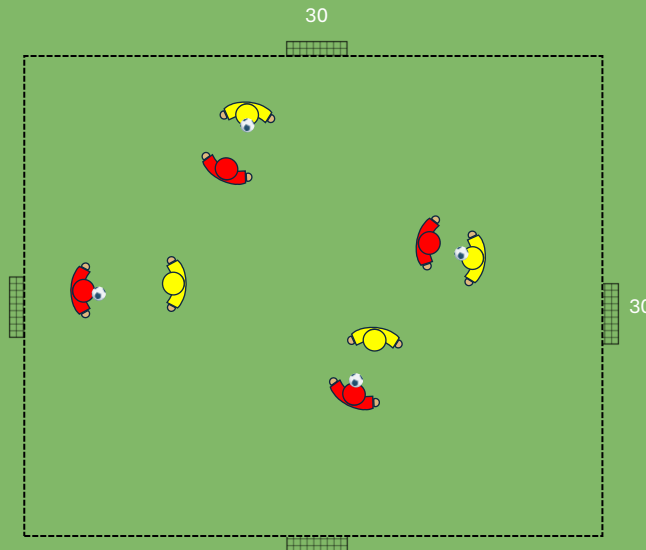
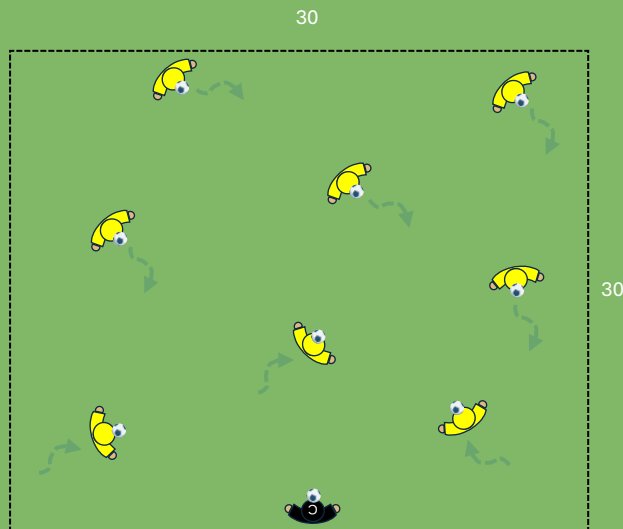
### End – Play With A Reward

- Finish session with a game,
- Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme,
- **Reward:** If you can beat a player 1v1 before scoring = 3 goals.
- Every other goal is worth 1.
- If working on defence, you can base the additional points around a player making a tackle.

Encourage 1v1 play and praise effort. Allow the players the freedom to play!

#### Coach Self Reflection:

- Did you create a T.O.E.S environment? (Touches of the ball, Organisation, Enjoyment and Safety).
- Did you start and end with play?
- Did you teach technique throughout the session?
- Were there smiles and laughter throughout the session?





# FINISHING

**Session Objective:** Improve our players technique and ability to finish with **either** placement or power.

## On Arrival – Start with play!

### Beginning – Fast Finishing

- Number the players in pairs.
- Players start the practice by dribbling inside the smaller inner grid showing their skills and close control.
- When the coach calls out your number (“1!”), those players must take a touch outside grid and score. Players must finish in different goals.
- Players collect ball after finishing and re-enter dribbling area. Repeat.

### Possible Progressions:

- Rotate GK’s each round.
- If you can score in the corners = 2 points.
- One you shoot, before collecting your ball, you lay off the next player called.

### Coaching Points:

- Technique of finishing (plant foot, swing and push through centre of the ball, type of finish – placement (inside foot) or power (laces) dependant on what you wish to focus on today.

## Middle – Numbers Game

- Number each team 1-3.
- When the coach calls your number (“1+2!”), you enter the field and play a mini game.
- Once ball is dead, players return to their area.
- When serving the ball, make sure you play in at an angle, so players don’t meet the ball dead on and potentially collide.

### Possible Progressions:

- Call progressively more players out (1v1, 2v2, 3v3)
- Rotate GK’s
- 3 Points if you can score within 6 seconds of getting the ball.

## End – Play With A Reward

- Finish session with a game,
- Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme,
- **Reward:** If you can score into one of the corners of the goal = 3 goals.
- Every other goal is worth 1.

Encourage creative finishing and praise effort. Allow the players the freedom to play!

### Coach Self Reflection:

- Did you create a T.O.E.S environment? (Touches of the ball, Organisation, Enjoyment and Safety).
- Did you start and end with play?
- Did you teach technique throughout the session?
- Were there smiles and laughter throughout the session?

